“WE WANT MAHARASHTRA TO BE INDIA’S MOST DIVERSE AND FUTURE-READY TOURISM DESTINATION.”



Shri Shambhuraj Desai
Minister of Tourism, Government of Maharashtra

Tourism is a key pillar of the Viksit Maharashtra Vision 2047. What are the key milestones you hope to achieve by the end of this decade?

Maharashtra has always had a natural edge in tourism, thanks to the sheer diversity that few states can match. Building on that strength, our focus now is a more integrated, future-ready approach, one where tourism experiences over the next few years are seamless, sustainable, and truly world-class. We’re working on stronger connectivity, better destination infrastructure, broader digital services, greater private-sector participation, and Destination Management Organizations (DMOs) to professionally manage destinations, improve visitor experiences, and build stronger destination branding. We are also developing multi-thematic tourism circuits that encourage visitors to explore more of the state and stay longer. Just as important, we want this growth to reach every corner of Maharashtra, not just the well-known circuits, by giving emerging destinations the same push as established ones, while creating greater opportunities for local communities through skilling, entrepreneurship, and tourism-led livelihoods. Tourism success is no longer measured by footfall alone, but by the quality of experiences, increased length of stay, higher visitor spending, and the tangible economic value created for local communities. That’s the direction Maharashtra is steadily headed in.

The Viksit Maharashtra Vision 2047 proposes five priority tourism circuits and thematic sub-circuits. How will these improve the visitor experience and encourage longer stays in Maharashtra?

Today’s traveller seeks a complete experience rather than simply ticking destinations off a list, and that is the thinking behind our tourism circuits. We are developing 100 thematic sub-circuits across eight tourism themes to showcase Maharashtra’s diverse tourism offerings in an integrated manner. Instead of promoting individual attractions in isolation, we are connecting heritage, spiritual, coastal, wildlife, experiential, and MICE destinations into curated travel routes supported by quality infrastructure and better last-mile connectivity. The circuits will also diversify tourism experiences by bringing lesser-known destinations and new tourism projects into the mainstream, helping spread visitor footfall beyond established hotspots and unlocking the tourism potential of emerging regions. By enabling tourists to experience multiple facets of Maharashtra in a single journey, these integrated circuits will increase the average length of stay, distribute tourism benefits more evenly across the State, and create new opportunities for local entrepreneurs, artisans, and hospitality businesses.

With the upcoming Simhastha Kumbh Mela in Nashik, how is Maharashtra preparing to deliver a world-class pilgrimage experience while ensuring efficient crowd management and infrastructure?

Simhastha is a matter of pride for Maharashtra. Our priority is to ensure that every devotee and tourist has a safe, smooth, and memorable experience. Preparations are already underway in coordination with all departments on roads, transport, sanitation, accommodation, healthcare, and security, while technology will help manage crowds and keep pilgrims updated in real time. Alongside these efforts, we are developing the Ramkal Path corridor in Nashik to